



OPENAI SOLUTIONS ENGINEERING

From fragmented supply-chain signals to governed decisions

A proposed OpenAI platform approach for Zeiss Supply Chain Management and IT leadership



TL;DR

OpenAI becomes the governed decision layer between ZEISS supply-chain data and operational action.

| Executive chat experience

| Enterprise integration and control layer

Problem

Context is split across SAP, logistics, suppliers and files.

Platform move

A central communication interface gives leaders **one decision surface**; the API integrates tools and controls.

Pilot

Start with one high-value workflow and validate faster triage, evidence quality and governed approvals.



Status quo and validation needs

Known operating context



- Advanced manufacturing, medical technology, quality and optics domains
- Decisions draw on SAP, supplier, logistics and document context
- Value depends on trustworthy answers, not another dashboard

Discovery hypotheses to validate

- Which disruptions consume the most time?
- Where do handoffs reduce accuracy or predictability?
- Which recommendations need evidence, review and traceability?



Providing a decision framework for existing data

SAP

- POs
- Material master
- MRP exceptions

Warehouse

- EWM stock
- Goods receipts
- Production buffers

Carriers

- DHL / FedEx
- ETA changes
- Customs events

Suppliers

- Commit dates
- Capacity
- Quality status

Files

- Scorecards
- Excel trackers
- Contracts

PAIN

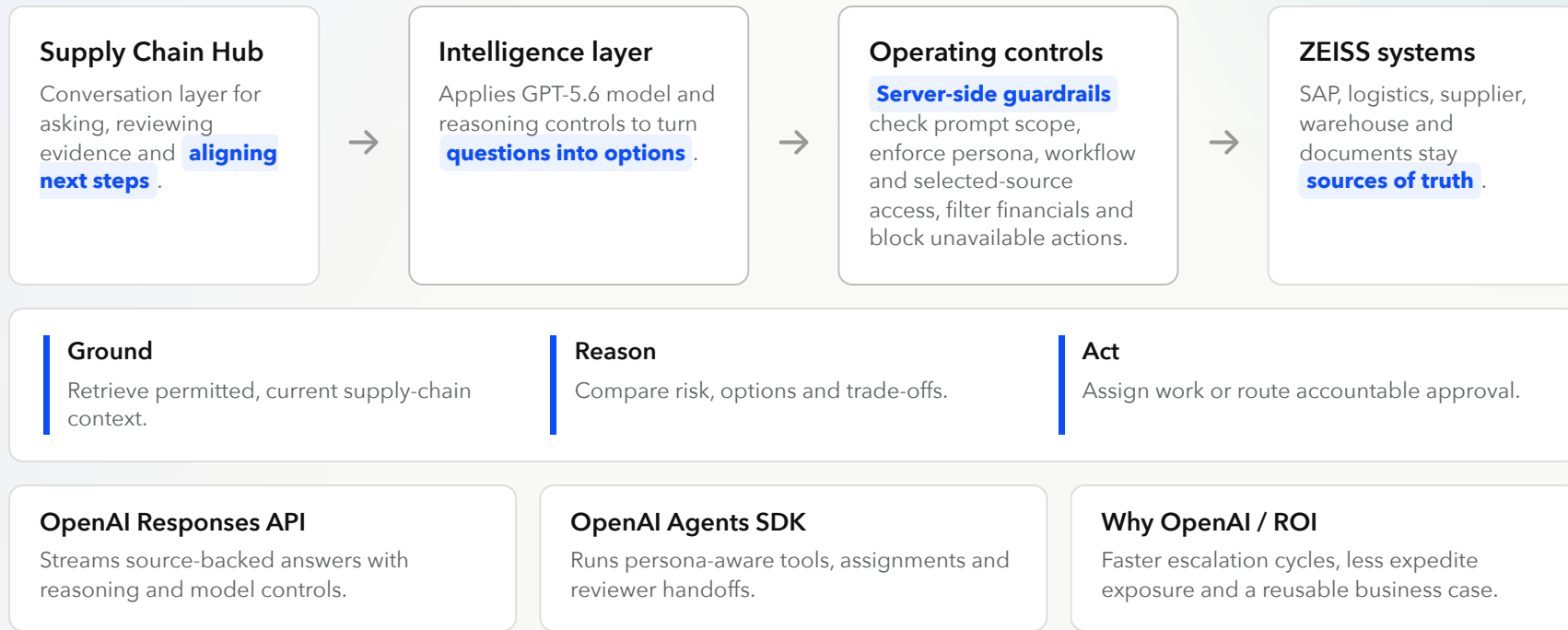
- Manual effort to reconstruct one trusted view
- Answer accuracy varies by source snapshot
- Low precision for lead-time and supplier risk
- Reliability depends on scarce experts

COST

- Expedite spend and buffers absorb uncertainty
- Leadership time shifts into escalation meetings
- Late mitigation creates schedule churn
- Scattered evidence increases quality exposure

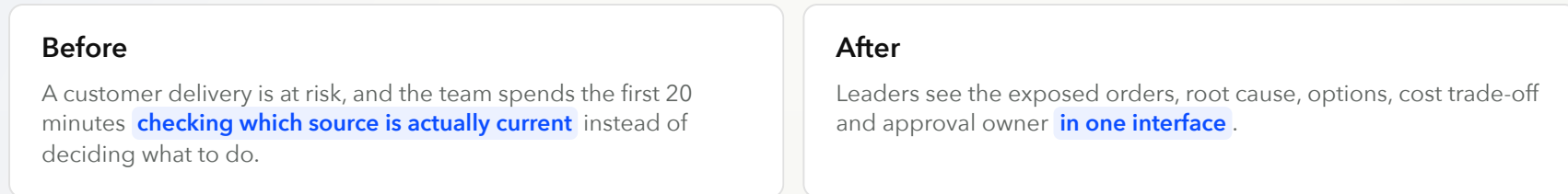
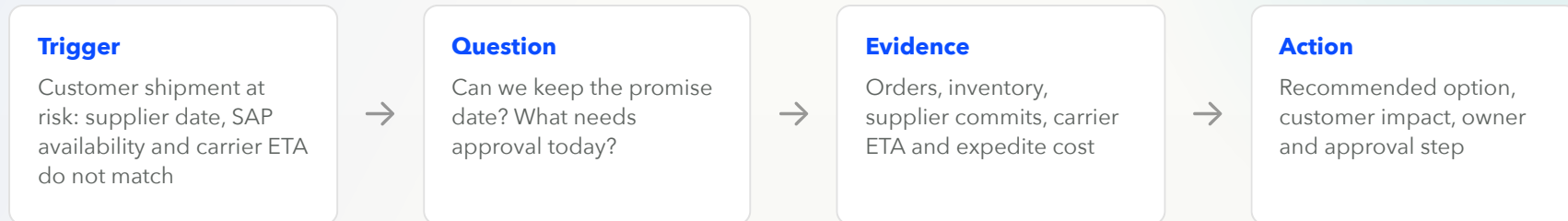


Solution overview





Executive workflow



Deployment constraints to validate

Data & privacy

Approved fields only; confirm GDPR, supplier confidentiality, retention and regional processing.

Identity & governance

SSO, server-side roles, masking and a named reviewer for every high-impact action.

Operations & adoption

Fail-closed fallback, process owner, training, feedback and security / works-council checkpoints.

OpenAI data control: API data is not used for model training unless the customer opts in. Retention and residency depend on eligible project, endpoint and configuration.

Demo



Impact validation and success criteria

Prove value, quality and control with a ZEISS SME-labelled gold set, trace review and explicit release gates.

1

Illustrative value hypothesis

€180K-€310K

Potential annual gross value · validate against the ZEISS baseline

€15K-€25K

Analyst capacity

600-1,000 reviews × 20 min ×
€75/hour

€101K-€151K

Avoided expedites

12-18 cases × €8,400

€65K-€130K

Downtime exposure

0.35-0.70 events × €185,000

Scale gate Net ROI = (validated benefit – annualized solution cost) ÷ annualized solution cost.

2

Evaluation loop and owned gates

1

SME-labelled gold set

2

Graders

3

Trace + SME review

4

Regression set

Process owner

≥25% faster · ≥80% useful

Supply-chain SME

≥90% source-faithful · ≤5% critical false negatives

Engineering owner

≥95% correct tool / trace path

Risk owner

100% high-impact review



Time to value

WEEK 0**Align**

Sponsor, workflow owner, success metrics, data boundaries.

WEEK 1**Connect**

Representative sources, role scopes, approval policy.

WEEK 2**Build**

App workflow, business tools, grounding and audit trail.

WEEK 3**Validate**

User feedback, answer quality checks, security review.

WEEK 4**Decide**

Impact readout, guardrail review, pilot recommendation.

After the POC**Weeks 5-8 • Pilot**

Harden one workflow and onboard the first team.

Weeks 9-12 • Adopt

Embed ownership, feedback and support.

Next • Scale the blueprint

Reuse the pattern across Procurement, Quality, Manufacturing and Finance.

How OpenAI can support adoption**Solutions Engineering**

Architecture, POC build and evals.

Enterprise support

Deployment readiness and escalation path.

Optional delivery services

Embedded help for production integration.

Lean customer core: one business owner + one technical lead; sponsor and SMEs join checkpoints.

Looking forward to shaping the collaboration between ZEISS and OpenAI!

Annex



Behind the scenes

App experience

- Next.js App Router, React and strict TypeScript
- GPT-5.6 Sol, Terra and Luna with six reasoning levels
- Persona-aware tools, source settings, answer copy and feedback controls

Grounded chat and guardrails

- `/api/chat` runs prompt-scope checks before context, sources or tools
- Server context enforces role scope, selected sources and masked fields
- Responses streaming with deterministic workbook and demo fallbacks

Agentic actions and integrations

- `/api/actions` enforces persona, workflow and source eligibility
- Explicit assignee and reviewer metadata drives tasks and approvals
- Role-aware Microsoft 365 grouping, reviewer handoffs and trace flushing

Decision support and delivery

- Model-selected savings-relationship bubble or matrix; trusted records stay server-owned
- Server-derived decision colors align recommendations across both views
- Vitest, strict typecheck and OpenNext/Wrangler delivery to Cloudflare Workers